

Feb 19. 2026

Left to their own devices

Observer: Aiden Thomas

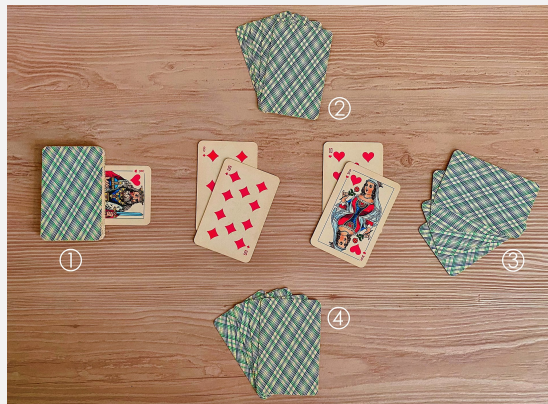
Teacher: Eric Baez

Reflections on Classroom Observation

This week, Eric continued to provide me with a comprehensive set of student expectations, which outlined the submission criteria required for the AP Computer Science Principles (APCSP) program. A challenge I faced today was that some students already submitted, so they were not interested in anything really and were looking for wallpapers. As a result, I taught them the Russian Card game *Durak*, I noticed a meaningful overlap between the two courses and thought they might want to build a card game as another portfolio submission, as students would draw upon programming techniques and tools introduced in Video Game Design to fulfill their APCSP portfolio requirements. This highlighted the natural transferability of skills, even when the work extends beyond the boundaries of the original curriculum.

Problem 1: Adaptability

(a) Below is an image of *Durak*.



Moving forward, I intend to refine my approach to assignment design and structure, ensuring that tasks are more accessible and relevant to students who are just beginning their journey with computer science. Comfortability: **7/10** I selected this rating because I recognize that I still need to recalibrate my expectations when working with students who have had significantly less exposure to programming compared to those at the college level.